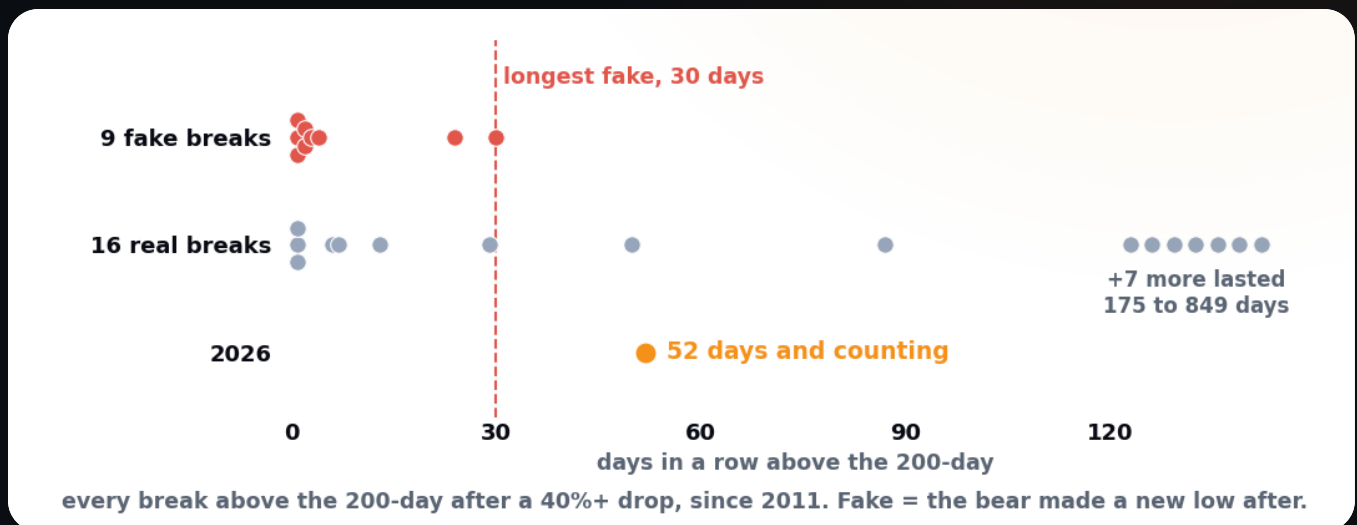


THE 200-DAY STUDY

Bitcoin has closed above its 200-day average 52 days in a row. Every time it broke above after a crash of 40% or more since 2011, 25 breaks, which were real, which were fake, and how long the fakes lasted.

Plus the 200-day as a regime since 2012, what the real breaks did next, how late it turned at every top and bottom, and the two lines that matter for 2026.



30 days

the longest any fake break lasted

0 of 9

breaks of 40+ days that were fake

52 days

this one, and counting

Educational, not financial advice. A break is a run of daily closes above the 200-day average that starts at least 40% under the all-time high. A fake means price later fell under that bear's low before a new all-time high.



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EVERY BREAK

25 BREAKS, 9 FAKES

FIRST CLOSE ABOVE	LAST CLOSE ABOVE	DAYS IN A ROW	UNDER THE HIGH AT THE START	THE BEAR'S LOW	RESULT
18 Mar 2012	24 Mar 2012	7	-65%	\$2.50	real
26 Mar 2012	04 Jul 2013	466	-68%	\$2.50	real
07 Jul 2013	01 Oct 2013	87	-71%	\$45.00	real
03 Oct 2013	26 Mar 2014	175	-55%	\$45.00	real
02 Jun 2014	03 Jun 2014	2	-43%	\$340	FAKE
05 Jun 2014	05 Jun 2014	1	-43%	\$340	FAKE
07 Jun 2014	08 Jun 2014	2	-43%	\$340	FAKE
30 Jun 2014	23 Jul 2014	24	-45%	\$340	FAKE
25 Jul 2014	25 Jul 2014	1	-48%	\$340	FAKE
01 Aug 2014	01 Aug 2014	1	-49%	\$340	FAKE
07 Aug 2014	10 Aug 2014	4	-50%	\$340	FAKE
29 Jun 2015	17 Aug 2015	50	-78%	\$152	real
06 Oct 2015	06 Oct 2015	1	-79%	\$152	real
10 Oct 2015	04 Feb 2018	849	-79%	\$152	real
08 Feb 2018	09 Mar 2018	30	-58%	\$5,921	FAKE
11 Mar 2018	13 Mar 2018	3	-52%	\$5,921	FAKE
02 Apr 2019	25 Sep 2019	177	-75%	\$3,122	real
26 Oct 2019	07 Nov 2019	13	-53%	\$3,122	real
28 Jan 2020	25 Feb 2020	29	-52%	\$3,122	real
27 Feb 2020	27 Feb 2020	1	-55%	\$3,122	real
02 Mar 2020	07 Mar 2020	6	-55%	\$3,122	real
29 Apr 2020	18 May 2021	385	-55%	\$3,122	real
13 Jan 2023	16 Aug 2023	216	-71%	\$15,479	real
29 Aug 2023	29 Aug 2023	1	-60%	\$15,479	real
16 Oct 2023	03 Jul 2024	262	-59%	\$15,479	real
19 Aug 2026	still going	52	-45%	\$57,735	?

Bitstamp daily closes from September 2011. 200-day = simple average of the last 200 closes. Bear's low = the lowest wick between the last all-time high and the break. Short breaks happened in both groups. None of the 9 fakes lasted past 30 days, and all 9 breaks of 40+ days were real.

THE FAKES

EVERY FAKE, AND WHAT CAME AFTER

BREAK	DAYS IN A ROW	THE BEAR'S LOW THEN	THE NEXT LOW	DATE	BELOW THE OLD LOW
02 Jun 2014	2	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
05 Jun 2014	1	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
07 Jun 2014	2	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
30 Jun 2014	24	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
25 Jul 2014	1	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
01 Aug 2014	1	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
07 Aug 2014	4	\$340	\$152	14 Jan 2015	-55%
08 Feb 2018	30	\$5,921	\$3,122	15 Dec 2018	-47%
11 Mar 2018	3	\$5,921	\$3,122	15 Dec 2018	-47%

The next low = the lowest wick after the break and before the next all-time high.

All nine came in two bears. Seven in the summer of 2014, when Bitcoin kept poking above a falling 200-day and falling back. The longest of them lasted 24 days. Two in February and March 2018, the longest 30 days. Both bears went on to much lower lows, 55% under the 2014 low and 47% under the February 2018 low.

THE REAL ONES

WHAT THE LONG BREAKS DID NEXT

FIRST CLOSE ABOVE	DAYS IN A ROW	UNDER THE HIGH ON DAY 52	A YEAR AFTER DAY 52	LAST CLOSE ABOVE
26 Mar 2012	466	-66%	+2,149%	04 Jul 2013
07 Jul 2013	87	-55%	+335%	01 Oct 2013
03 Oct 2013	175	-5%	-56%	26 Mar 2014
29 Jun 2015	50	ended before day 52		17 Aug 2015
10 Oct 2015	849	-68%	+94%	04 Feb 2018
02 Apr 2019	177	-60%	+16%	25 Sep 2019
29 Apr 2020	385	-53%	+282%	18 May 2021
13 Jan 2023	216	-67%	+205%	16 Aug 2023
16 Oct 2023	262	-37%	+122%	03 Jul 2024

Every break of 40+ days since 2011. All real. Measured from the close on day 52 of each one, the same day count 2026 is on.

Seven of eight were higher a year later. The exception, October 2013, was only 5% under its all-time high on day 52 and ran straight into the November 2013 cycle top. 2026 is 35% under its high. Every one of these runs ended with a close back under the 200-day at some point, and in none of them did price go back under the bear's low.

THE REGIME TEST

ABOVE VS BELOW, SINCE 2012

FROM EVERY DAILY CLOSE	ABOVE, HIGHER AFTER	ABOVE, TYPICAL MOVE	BELOW, HIGHER AFTER	BELOW, TYPICAL MOVE
30 days later	60%	+5%	54%	+1%
90 days later	68%	+19%	47%	-3%
180 days later	74%	+45%	49%	-3%

Typical = median. Every close since the 200-day first existed in 2012.

INSIDE EACH BEAR, TOP TO FINAL LOW	BUY AND HOLD	HOLD ONLY ABOVE THE 200-DAY
2014 bear	-85%	-65%
2018 bear	-83%	-67%
2022 bear	-76%	-34%
2026 bear, top to the July low	-52%	-20%

The rule holds Bitcoin only on days after a close above the 200-day, cash otherwise, 0.1% per switch.

The everyday claim holds up. Above the 200-day the odds tilt up, below it they are close to a coin toss with a negative typical move. A rule that only held Bitcoin above the line lost far less in every bear, but it switched 92 times since April 2012 and 56 of 92 crosses reversed within 10 days. Over the whole period it ended close to buy and hold, about 16,192 times the money against 16,849, with a worst drop of -71% against -85%.

THE COST OF WAITING

HOW LATE THE 200-DAY TURNED

TURN	PRICE	200-DAY SIGNAL	DATE	CLOSE THAT DAY	GAP
2013 top	\$1,163	first close under	27 Mar 2014	\$475	-59% from the top
2017 top	\$19,666	first close under	05 Feb 2018	\$6,874	-65% from the top
2021 top	\$69,000	first close under	13 Dec 2021	\$46,725	-32% from the top
2025 top	\$126,272	first close under	17 Oct 2025	\$106,476	-16% from the top
2015 bottom	\$152	first close above	29 Jun 2015	\$256	+68% from the low
2018 bottom	\$3,122	first close above	02 Apr 2019	\$4,900	+57% from the low
2022 bottom	\$15,479	first close above	13 Jan 2023	\$19,931	+29% from the low
2026 July low	\$57,735	first close above	19 Aug 2026	\$69,298	+20% from the low

First daily close under the 200-day after each top, and first close above it after each bottom.

The 200-day never catches a top or a bottom. It flipped down 16% to 65% after each top, and back up 20% to 68% after each bottom. That lateness is the price of the filter. In 2026 it flipped up on 19 August at \$69,298, 20% off the July low, the earliest of the four.

THE LIVE CASE

2026, DAY 52



Bitcoin closed at \$82,562 on 09 October, 15% above a 200-day of \$71,857, and the 200-day is rising. It has closed above it 52 days in a row since 19 August, 22 days past the longest fake on record.

Two lines matter from here. A daily close under the 200-day, now \$71,857 and moving up, ends the streak, which every real break also did eventually. A break of \$57,735, the July low, is what every fake did and no real break ever did.

THE READ

No fake ever lasted past 30 days. \$57,735 is still the line.

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

A BREAK COUNTS AFTER A DROP OF	BREAKS	FAKES	LONGEST FAKE	FAKES AMONG 40+ DAY BREAKS
20%+	38	16	30 days	0
25%+	34	12	30 days	0
30%+	26	10	30 days	0
40%+ (this study)	25	9	30 days	0

The same test with a looser crash filter. The answer does not change. MA200/ma_check3.py.

Two bears made all the fakes. Nine fakes from 2014 and 2018 is a small sample, and the 2022 bear never got above its 200-day at all after its crash. A fake longer than 30 days has simply never happened, which is not the same as impossible.

A long break is not a straight line. Every real break in the table ended with a close back under the 200-day at some point, and the recoveries all had pullbacks of 20% or more along the way.

The 200-day is slow. It confirms late at every turn, and it whipsaws. Most crosses since 2012 reversed within 10 days.

Data pinned to the 09 October 2026 close. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily. Scripts: MA200/ma_study.py, MA200/ma_regime.py, MA200/ma_check3.py, MA200/ma_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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